Welcome to NEW HOPE Church

A Safe Place to Know Jesus, Love Jesus, and Serve Jesus

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to recommend to you Aiden Nickel for the Mountain Scholarship Award. He will be entering full-time studies in the fall of 2024 and has consistently served in our church and desires to make a difference outside of it.

I have known Aiden for that past three years as the Family Pastor of New Hope Church. For the last two years he has served as part of our "Youth Core" team, the leadership training program for nominated and selected members of our Sr Youth group. Aiden, along with 20 other Youth, has served by leading devotionals for other Youth Core and Leaders, teaching small group lessons he wrote, received feedback on, revised and delivered. He planned and prepared a night for our 150-person youth group, along with the rest of the Youth Core, and most importantly provided one on one support for younger youth that were not well integrated into the group.

Aiden showed his quality last year when his Life Group was particularly challenging. He was the only committed Youth in that group, all the other members had very sporadic attendance and were newer to getting to know Jesus or were only there because they were made to attend by their parents. Aiden, rather than asking to switch to one of the other thriving groups that included many serious young men eager to study the Bible, took the challenge of helping to curate the culture of the group and to encourage the leaders of his group. He made specific effort to connect with his Life Group members and encourage them to come each week.

In this situation Aiden took the initiative to study the Bible more deeply on his own and with other friends from Youth. He often asked for resources to further his study and displayed his academic potential through many conversations with me as well as his intellectual curiosity about many things.

Aiden has also served our whole church community by being out first cello player and serving in worship for 4 services about once a month. He does so with great humility and a servant attitude.

I believe Aiden is an excellent candidate for your scholarship,

Sarah Braun, HSc, Bed, OCT

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